Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

788
-11 -1.38%
Dec 18th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

899
-11.00 -1.21%
Dec 18th, 2024

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

707
-3 -0.42%
Dec 18th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

105.00
-1.00 -0.94%
Dec 18th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

117.85
-0.75 -0.63%
Dec 18th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

—
900
0 0.00%
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2505 (May) RMB/t (3pm close)

778.50
-18.00 -2.26%
Dec 18th, 2024 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
January 25 USD/dmt

102.65
-1.95 -1.86%
Dec 18th, 2024 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2505 (Jan) RMB/t

3312
-52 -1.55%
Dec 18th, 2024 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

16.75
-0.03 -0.18%
Dec 17th, 2024

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

6.85
-0.49 -6.68%
Dec 17th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3447
44 1.29%
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

146.66
0.82 0.56%
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

18.02
-0.04 -0.19%
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3502
2 0.06%
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Dec 18th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	788	-11	-1.4%	784	871	683	1063	101.70	-1.46	-1.4%	101.51	113.87	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	707	-3	-0.4%	695	764	610	963	91.86	-0.40	-0.4%	90.57	100.51	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	899	-11	-1.2%	896	982	794	1175	116.56	-1.45	-1.2%	116.54	128.93	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Dec 18th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	105.00	-1.00	-0.94%	104.44	115.21	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	117.85	-0.75	-0.63%	117.28	132.57	98.28	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, iron ore futures fluctuated downward. The most-traded I2505 contract finally closed at 778.5 yuan/mt, down 2.63% throughout the day. Traders showed a weak willingness to sell, while steel mills were cautiously observing, with a slight increase in purchase willingness. Market transactions were average today. In Shandong, the mainstream transaction prices of PB fines were 775-780 yuan/mt, down 10-15 yuan/mt from yesterday. In Tangshan, the transaction prices of PB fines were around 790 yuan/mt, also down 10-15 yuan/mt from yesterday.

This week, iron ore demand declined again. According to an SMM survey, as of December 18, the operating rate of blast furnaces at 242 steel mills surveyed by SMM was 85.47%, down 0.76 percentage points WoW. The capacity utilisation rate of blast furnaces was 87.01%, down 0.56 percentage points WoW. The daily pig iron production of the sample steel mills was 2.3476 million mt, down 15,000 mt WoW. The number of blast furnace maintenance cases continued to increase this week, mainly due to annual plans and environmental protection-driven production restrictions. In the short term, this situation is expected to persist, with a slight decline in pig iron production still possible in the near term.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	900	0	0.0%	885	1010	820	1210	111.85	0.37	0.33%	110.42	127.03	102.77	153.57

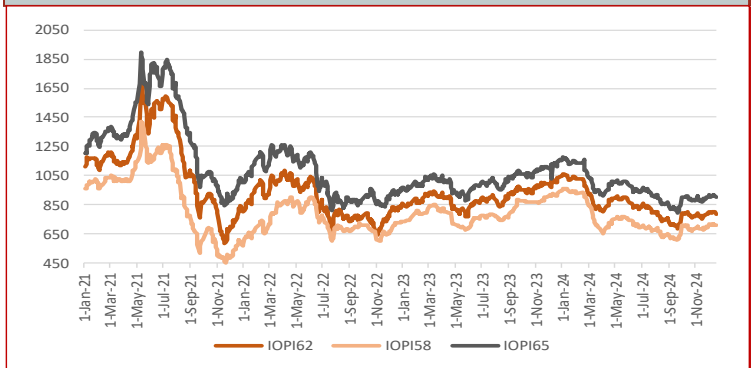
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	971	0.8%	861	1226	135.11	0.88%	122.41	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	990	0.0%	965	1300	137.75	0.05%	135.54	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	745	0.7%	715	970	103.66	0.73%	100.77	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1005	0.9%	905	1294	139.84	0.96%	128.66	182.16

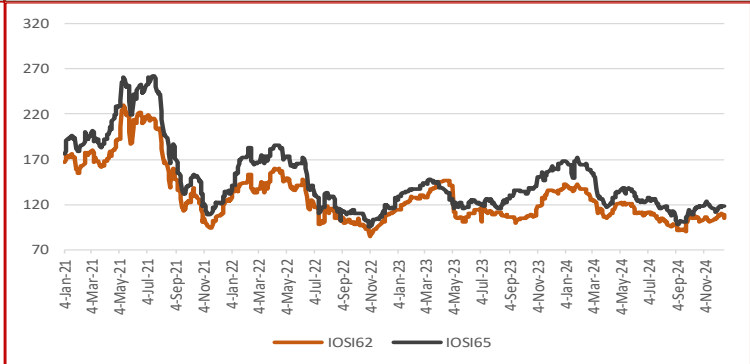
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	892.91	0.99%	854.16	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 18th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	765	718	781	779	784	765	871	99.33	93.70	102.03	100.71	101.51	99.31	113.87
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	656	630	690	692	695	673	764	85.58	82.73	90.61	89.97	90.57	87.82	100.51
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	876	829	894	891	896	877	982	114.39	108.89	117.10	115.71	116.54	114.39	128.93

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 18th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	99.33	94.36	104.02	103.09	104.44	101.13	115.21
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	114.06	102.24	115.31	117.71	117.28	113.01	132.57

FREIGHT RATES

Dec 17th, 2024		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	6.85	-0.49	-6.68%	6.80	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	16.75	-0.03	-0.18%	16.21	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	911	830	888	876	885	869	1010	114.10	104.46	111.82	109.09	110.42	108.72	127.03

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Dec 18th, 2024		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-81	-10.28%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	111	14.09%

Dec 18th, 2024		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	12.85	12.24%

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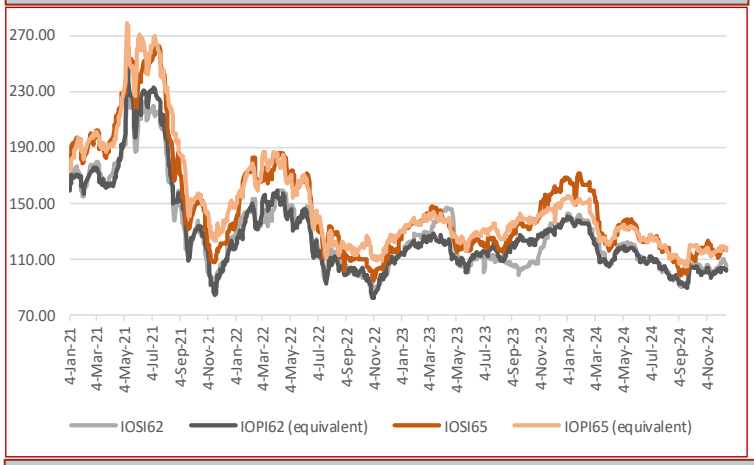
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Dec 18th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	731	-11	-57
SIMEC Fines	659	-11	-129
PB Fines	757	-11	-31
Newman Fines	756	-11	-32
MAC Fines	738	-11	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	652	-11	-136
Carajas Fines	968	-11	180
Brazilian SSF	750	-11	-38
Brazilian Blend Fines	770	-11	-18
RTX Fines	671	-11	-117
West Pilbara Fines	700	-11	-88

Dec 18th, 2024	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.50	-1.00	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	97.00	-1.00	-8.00
PB Fines	101.25	-1.00	-3.75
Newman Fines	104.15	-1.00	-0.85
MAC Fines	101.25	-1.00	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	93.65	-1.00	-11.35
Carajas Fines	134.55	-1.00	29.55
Brazilian SSF	108.75	-1.00	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	110.35	-1.00	5.35
RTX Fines	94.85	-1.00	-10.15
West Pilbara Fines	99.25	-1.00	-5.75

Dec 18th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	707	-3	0
FMG Blended Fines	716	-3	9
Robe River	716	-3	9
Western Fines	719	-3	12
Atlas Fines	713	-3	6
Yandi	700	-3	-7

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	21.00	1.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	35.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	18.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	30.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	8.00	-1.00
	Low Fe Grade	21.00	3.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	7.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	7.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	0.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	3.50	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	0.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	0.25	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.25	-0.25
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-50.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-25.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-10.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-30.00	0.00

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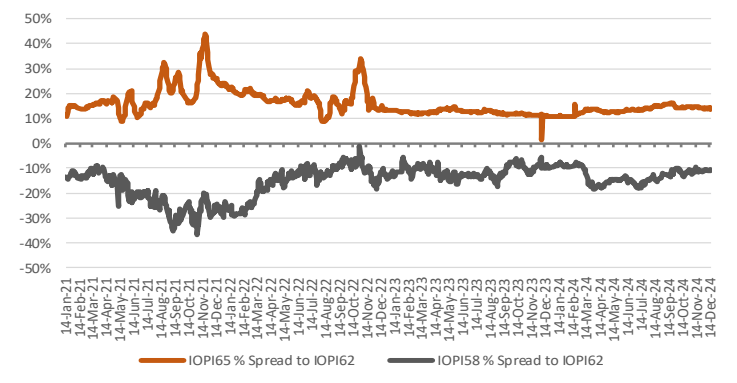
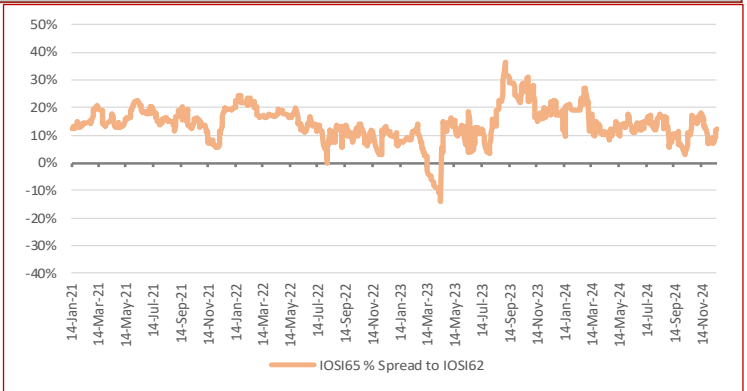
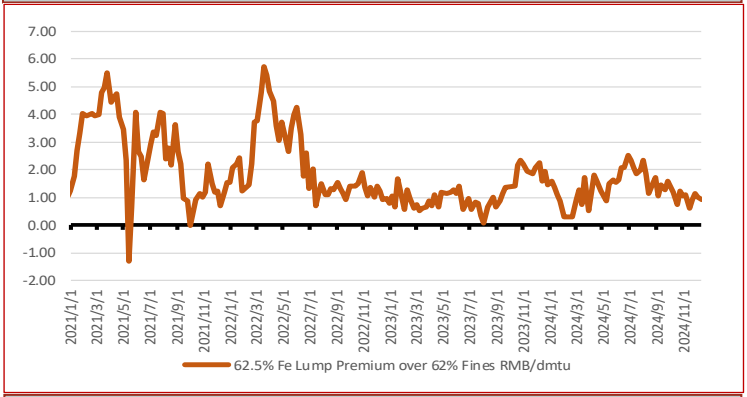
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

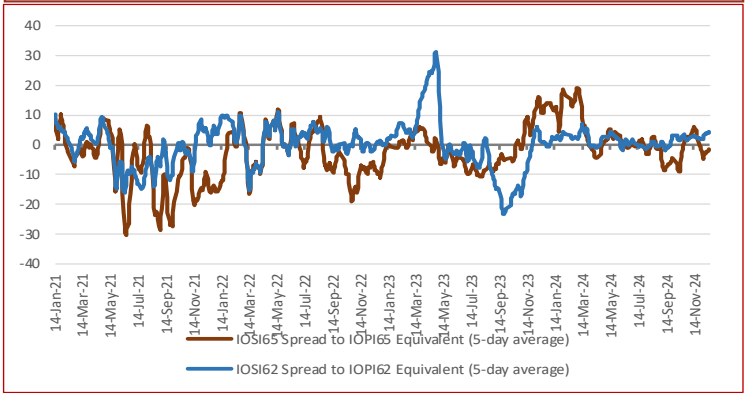




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

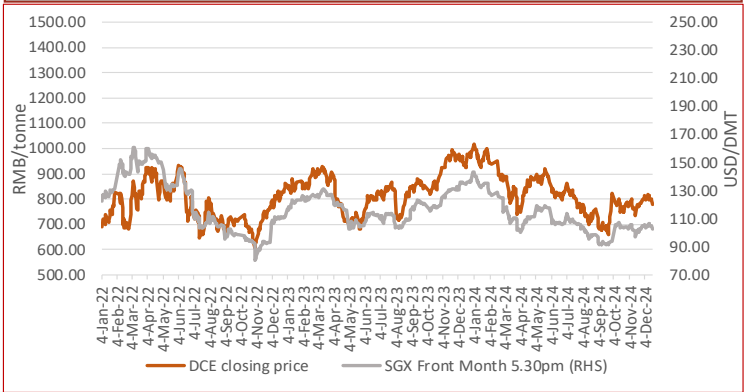


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

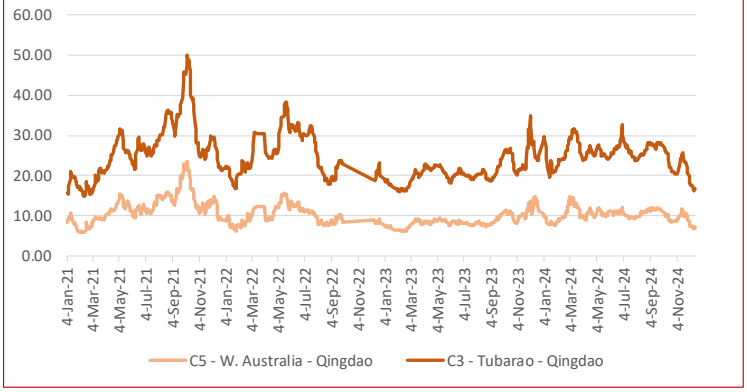
Week Ending Dec 13th, 2024

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	13.22	-1.42%	8.29	17.20
Qingdao	25.36	1.36%	22.28	25.81
Caofeidian	18.86	1.18%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	11.86	4.31%	6.64	12.16
Rizhao	19.21	-2.09%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	146.66	0.56%	105.01	150.72

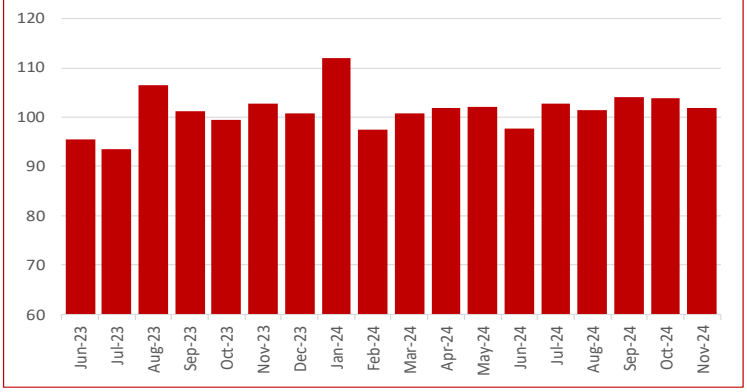
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Dec 18th, 3pm close			Dec 18th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2505	Change	Change %	Jan. 25	Change	Change %
Closing Price	778.50	-18.00	-2.26%	102.65	-1.95	-1.86%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	35.14	8.54	32.09%	8.07	2.84	54.32%
Open positions ('000 lots)	38.02	1.47	4.03%	35.59	0.70	1.99%
Day Low	776.5	-17.00	-2.14%	102.60	-1.80	-1.72%
Day High	797.0	-9.50	-1.18%	104.60	-1.20	-1.13%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2024/12/13	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,447	44	1.29%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,616	40	1.11%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,502	2	0.06%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,200	47	1.13%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,677	47	1.29%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,460	20	0.45%
Colour Coated Plate	6,850	100	1.48%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

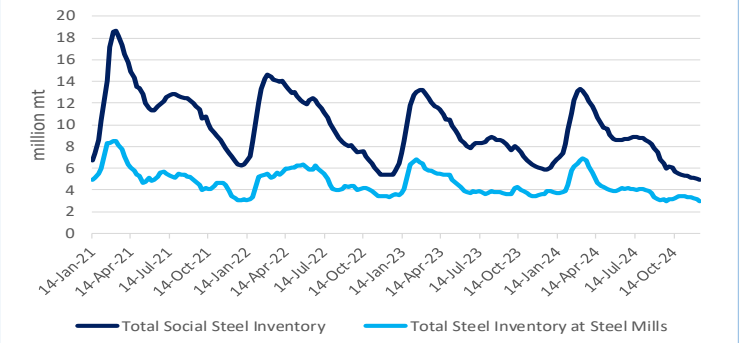
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	103.58	1.16	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,900	-55	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,560	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,713	-10	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,292	-12	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	78	22	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,363	-11	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	117	31	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

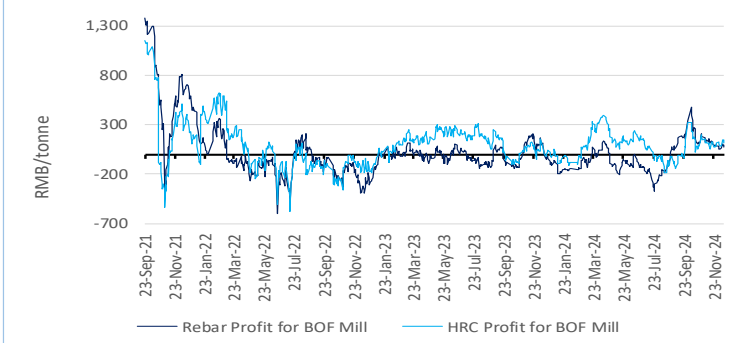
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

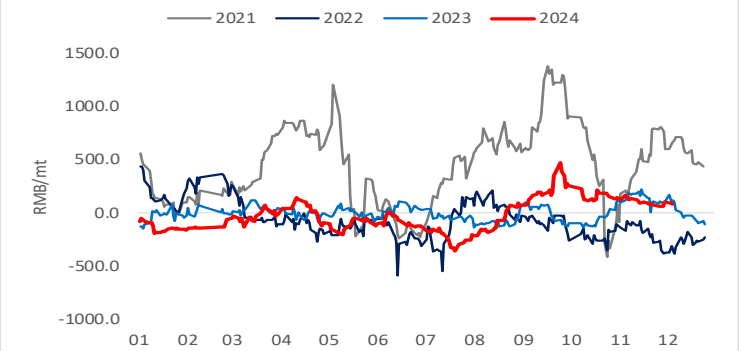
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

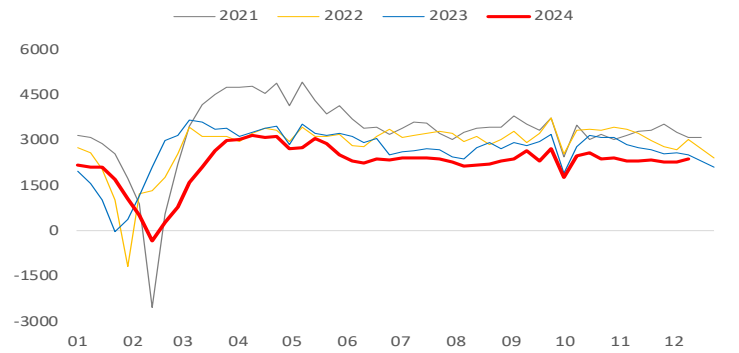


CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar

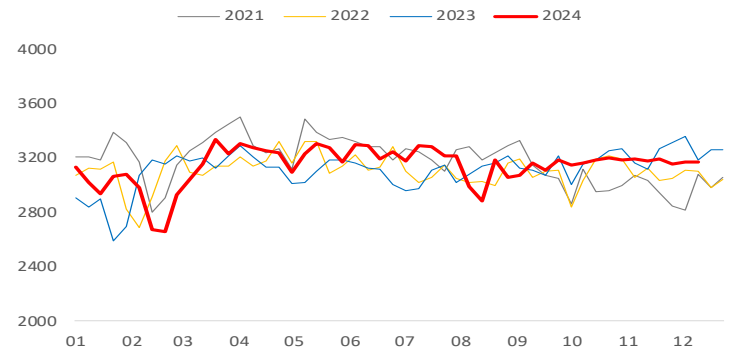


CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil

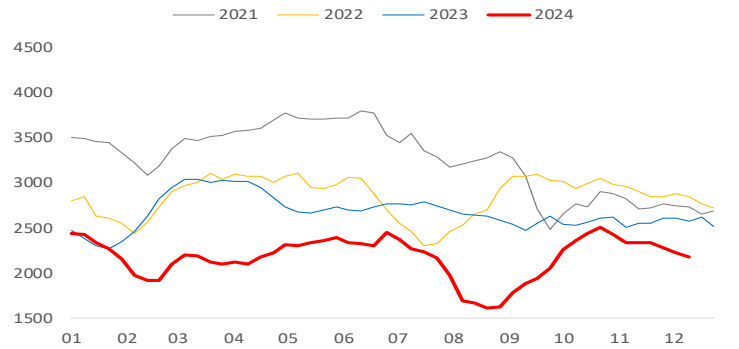
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



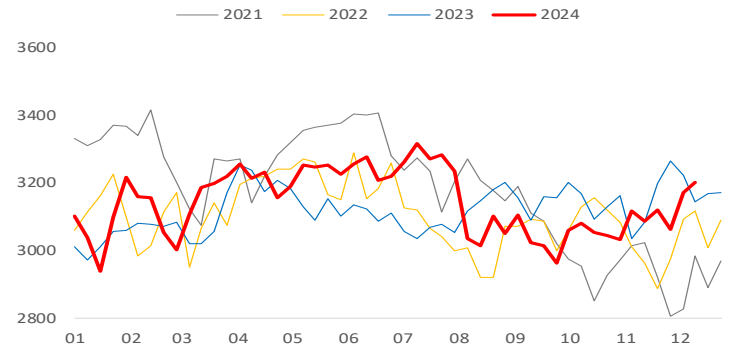
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Dec 18th, 2024	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Dec 18th, 2024	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

CONTACT US

MMI Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7629 E: prices@mmiprices.com
SMM Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7630 E: service.en@smm.cn
SMM Shanghai Office Details: 9th FL, Building 9, Lujiazui Software Park, No.20, Lane 91, Pudong, Shanghai Tel: +86 021 5155 0306 E: service.en@smm.cn

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